

What Is GivingTuesday?

Since its start in 2012, GivingTuesday, the Tuesday after Thanksgiving, has become one of the biggest money-raising days of the year for nonprofits in the United States.

In 2022 and 2023, GivingTuesday raised \$3.1 billion for charity, or aid, organizations, as estimated by GivingTuesday.

This year, GivingTuesday is on December 3.

How did GivingTuesday start?

The #GivingTuesday hashtag started as a project of the 92nd Street Y in New York City in 2012. It became an independent organization in 2020. It has grown into a worldwide organization of local groups that support giving in their communities, often on different dates that have local importance, like holidays.

Now, GivingTuesday, the nonprofit, also gathers researchers studying everyday giving. It also collects data from wide sources like payment processors, crowdfunding sites, employee giving software and organizations that offer charitable giving.

What is the purpose of GivingTuesday?

For nonprofits, the point of GivingTuesday is to raise money and engage their supporters. Many nonprofits will organize fundraising campaigns with email and mail appeals that arrive on the Tuesday after Thanksgiving.

Nonprofits do not have to be linked in any way with GivingTuesday, the organization, to run a fundraising campaign. GivingTuesday will still provide them with graphics and advice. In that way, it remains a grassroots effort with groups and donors taking part as they like.

Has GivingTuesday been successful?

GivingTuesday has grown far beyond its early days when it mainly pushed for giving on social media. The day has become a well-known event that seeks to center charitable giving and volunteering in the U.S. and around the world.

For years, GivingTuesday has been a major focus of fundraising for nonprofits, with many seeking to organize matching donations from major donors. It is the beginning of the end-of-year fundraising race as nonprofits seek to reach their budget targets for the following year.

Donations on GivingTuesday in 2022 and 2023 reached \$3.1 billion, an increase from \$2.7 billion in 2021. While that is a lot to raise in a single day, the trend last year was flat and fewer

donors were giving. The organization says that is a worrying sign.

I'm Caty Weaver.

The Associated Press reported this story. Caty Weaver adapted the story for VOA Learning English.

Vocabulary

hashtag - n. แฮชแท็ก – คำหรือวลีที่มีสัญลักษณ์ # นำหน้าเพื่อจัดหมวดหมู่หรือระบุประเภทของข้อความที่ตามมา (เช่นในทวิต)

crowdfunding - n. คราวด์ฟันดิง – การระดมทุนที่จำเป็น (เช่นสำหรับธุรกิจใหม่) โดยการขอรับเงินบริจาคจากผู้คนจำนวนมาก โดยเฉพาะจากชุมชนออนไลน์

graphics - n. กราฟิก – สื่อภาพ เช่น รูปภาพ แผนที่ แผนที่ แผนที่ เป็นต้น

focus - n. จุดเน้น/ความสนใจ – ความสนใจเป็นพิเศษที่คุณให้สิ่งใดสิ่งหนึ่ง

matching - adj. จับคู่/เท่ากัน – มีจำนวนเท่ากัน

trend - n. แนวโน้ม – การเคลื่อนไหวโดยทั่วไป

Reading Comprehension Quiz

1. When did GivingTuesday originally begin?

- A. The Tuesday after Thanksgiving
- B. In 2012
- C. In the United States
- D. When nonprofits started raising money

2. According to Paragraph 2, what is GivingTuesday recognized as in the United States?

- A. A national holiday
- B. The biggest shopping day
- C. One of the biggest money-raising days for nonprofits
- D. A day for family gatherings

3. How much money did GivingTuesday raise in total for charity organizations in 2022 and 2023?

- A. \$2.7 billion
- B. \$3.1 million
- C. \$3.1 billion
- D. Billions over many years

4. When is GivingTuesday observed this year, according to the article?

- A. The last Tuesday of November
- B. After Thanksgiving
- C. On December 3
- D. On the first Tuesday of December

5. Where did the #GivingTuesday hashtag project initially originate?

- A. As an independent organization
- B. From a global community effort
- C. At the 92nd Street Y in New York City
- D. On social media platforms

6. In what year did GivingTuesday become an independent organization?

- A. 2012
- B. 2020
- C. 2022
- D. 2023

7. Besides organizing giving campaigns, what other role does the GivingTuesday nonprofit play?

- A. It designs fundraising graphics for various organizations.
- B. It conducts research and collects data on everyday giving.
- C. It directly manages crowdfunding sites for new businesses.
- D. It provides employee giving software to companies.

8. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a source from which GivingTuesday collects data?

- A. Payment processors
- B. Government grants
- C. Crowdfunding sites
- D. Employee giving software

9. What are the two main objectives for nonprofits participating in GivingTuesday?

- A. To provide financial advice and offer volunteering opportunities.
- B. To secure government funding and expand their reach globally.
- C. To raise money and engage their supporters.
- D. To develop new software and study giving trends.

10. What kind of support does GivingTuesday, the organization, offer to nonprofits that are not formally linked to it but wish to run campaigns?

- A. Direct financial funding
- B. Volunteer staff and event coordination
- C. Graphics and advice
- D. Legal consultation and marketing services

11. How is GivingTuesday characterized in terms of participation from groups and donors, according to Paragraph 10?

- A. As a centrally controlled, top-down initiative.
- B. As a highly regulated and exclusive event.
- C. As a grassroots effort with voluntary participation.
- D. As a mandatory annual observance for all nonprofits.

12. How has GivingTuesday primarily evolved since its early focus on social media?

- A. It has become exclusively a U.S. event.
- B. It now primarily focuses on political advocacy.
- C. It has transformed into a well-known event centering charitable giving and volunteering worldwide.
- D. It has shifted its focus entirely to corporate sponsorships.

13. What specific fundraising method do many nonprofits employ on GivingTuesday, involving significant contributors?

- A. Crowdfunding from the general public.
- B. Soliciting small, individual contributions.
- C. Organizing matching donations from major donors.
- D. Relying solely on government grants.

14. What does GivingTuesday signify the start of for nonprofits, in terms of their financial planning?

- A. The beginning of their annual budgeting process.
- B. The end-of-year fundraising race.
- C. A period for staff holidays.
- D. The review of previous year's performance.

15. Despite an overall increase in funds raised, what worrying trend did GivingTuesday observe last year?

- A. A decrease in the total amount of money raised.

- B. An increase in the number of participating nonprofits.
- C. A flat trend in donations and fewer donors giving.
- D. A shift towards corporate donations over individual giving.